

EA1 Reflection

Activity Description

For my activity I participated in the Spokane Cybercup. This activity entailed me traveling to Gonzaga University on Saturday February 7th and spending the day solving jeopardy-style cybersecurity challenges alongside my team.

Technical Decisions

From a technical perspective I made several important decisions. First, I coordinated with my team to see what specialties we all have given the cybersecurity challenges. I also coordinated with the cybersecurity club to ensure I got placed with a team of similar skill level so no one person would be carrying the team. We split the challenges by skill level and passed off challenges that we were unable to solve so others could attempt them. Other technical decisions included pre-downloading common software used in competition such as Wireshark, Autopsy, WSL, Exiftool, etc. I also had a pre-prepared kali linux virtual machine with pre-installed tools in case more tools were necessary.

Contributions

My specialties included log analysis, packet analysis, and OSINT for this competition. There were also several 'physical challenges' that were meant to test physical security skills — I think they were mostly just for fun — and I was selected by the team to do those challenges. A list of my contributions is provided below:

1. Solved all three physical challenges that centered around lockpicking
2. Solved several OSINT challenges surrounding reverse image search and location finding
3. Solved several log analysis challenges
4. Solved several linux-basics exercises
5. Attempted several challenges that I passed off partially finished for my team to help with

Quality Assessment

I would rate the quality of this event 10/10. Overall this event was a valuable learning experience. The focus of this event is on learning, so the coaches were very helpful and the challenges were geared to multiple experience levels. The event also provided the challenges and solution guides later so I could go back and see where I went wrong on certain challenges. I learned more from this CTF than I did from many others I participated in this semester. There was also the added stipulation that we weren't allowed to use AI tools to figure out the challenges which allowed everyone an equal chance to actually learn while doing the challenges.